

Test Strategy & RTM — Forgot Password Feature

Mock-Feature QA Documentation Project | Prepared by Anusha Yadav

1. User Story

As a registered user, I want to reset my password via email, so that I can regain access to my account if I forget it.

2. Acceptance Criteria

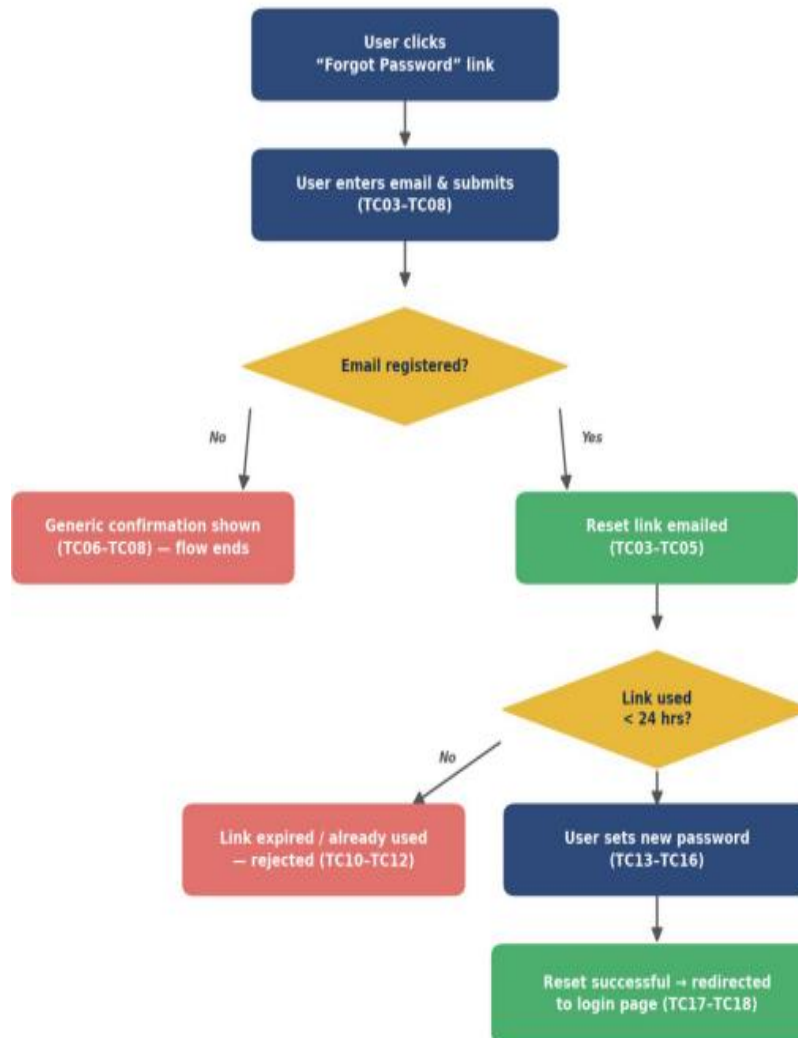
- User can access a "Forgot Password" link from the login page.
- Entering a valid, registered email sends a password-reset link to that email address.
- Entering an unregistered email shows a generic confirmation/error message (no confirmation of whether the email exists, to prevent email enumeration).
- The reset link expires 24 hours after it is generated.
- The new password must meet minimum requirements: at least 8 characters, including at least 1 number.
- After a successful password reset, the user is redirected to the login page with a success message.

3. Test Scenarios

Req.	Test Scenario
R1	Verify accessibility and navigation of the Forgot Password link
R2	Verify reset link is sent for a valid, registered email
R3	Verify system behavior when an unregistered email is submitted
R4	Verify reset link expiry after 24 hours
R5	Verify new password meets minimum strength requirements
R6	Verify redirection and confirmation after successful password reset

Visual: Test Flow

Forgot Password — Test Flow Overview



4. Test Cases

18 test cases across 6 requirements, covering positive, negative and boundary conditions.

ID	Req	Test Case Summary	Type	Priority
TC01	R1	Forgot Password link visible and clickable on login page	Positive	High
TC02	R1	Clicking link navigates to the Forgot Password page	Positive	High
TC03	R2	Submit a valid registered email; reset link should be sent	Positive	High
TC04	R2	Reset email received contains a working reset link	Positive	High
TC05	R2	Submitted email field is case-insensitive (e.g. Test@x.com vs test@x.com)	Positive	Medium
TC06	R3	Submit an unregistered email; generic message shown, no enumeration hint	Negative	High
TC07	R3	Submit an empty email field; validation error shown	Negative	Medium
TC08	R3	Submit an invalid email format (e.g. "abc@"); validation error shown	Negative	Medium
TC09	R4	Use reset link within 24 hours; link works and allows password reset	Positive	High
TC10	R4	Use reset link exactly at the 24-hour boundary	Boundary	Medium
TC11	R4	Use reset link after 24 hours have passed; link is expired/invalid	Negative	High
TC12	R4	Reuse an already-used reset link a second time; should be rejected	Negative	Medium
TC13	R5	Enter new password with exactly 8 characters + 1 number; should be accepted	Boundary	High
TC14	R5	Enter new password with 7 characters; should be rejected	Boundary	High
TC15	R5	Enter new password with 8+ characters but no number; should be rejected	Negative	Medium
TC16	R5	Enter new password with only spaces; should be rejected	Negative	Low
TC17	R6	Complete reset with valid password; redirected to login with success message	Positive	High
TC18	R6	After reset, log in using the new password successfully	Positive	High

5. Requirement Traceability Matrix (RTM)

Maps each acceptance-criteria requirement to the test cases covering it, confirming full coverage.

Req ID	Requirement Description	Test Case IDs	Coverage
R1	Forgot Password link accessible from login page	TC01, TC02	Covered
R2	Valid registered email triggers reset link	TC03, TC04, TC05	Covered
R3	Unregistered/invalid email handled without enumeration	TC06, TC07, TC08	Covered
R4	Reset link expires after 24 hours	TC09, TC10, TC11, TC12	Covered
R5	New password meets minimum strength requirements	TC13, TC14, TC15, TC16	Covered
R6	Successful reset redirects to login with confirmation	TC17, TC18	Covered

Coverage Summary: 6/6 requirements covered • 18 test cases designed • 100% requirement traceability achieved.



6. Summary

This document demonstrates the complete QA chain from requirement to test coverage for a mock "Forgot Password" feature: a user story, testable acceptance criteria, high-level test scenarios, detailed test cases (positive, negative and boundary), and a Requirement Traceability Matrix confirming full coverage. This approach can be applied to any feature during test planning on a real project.